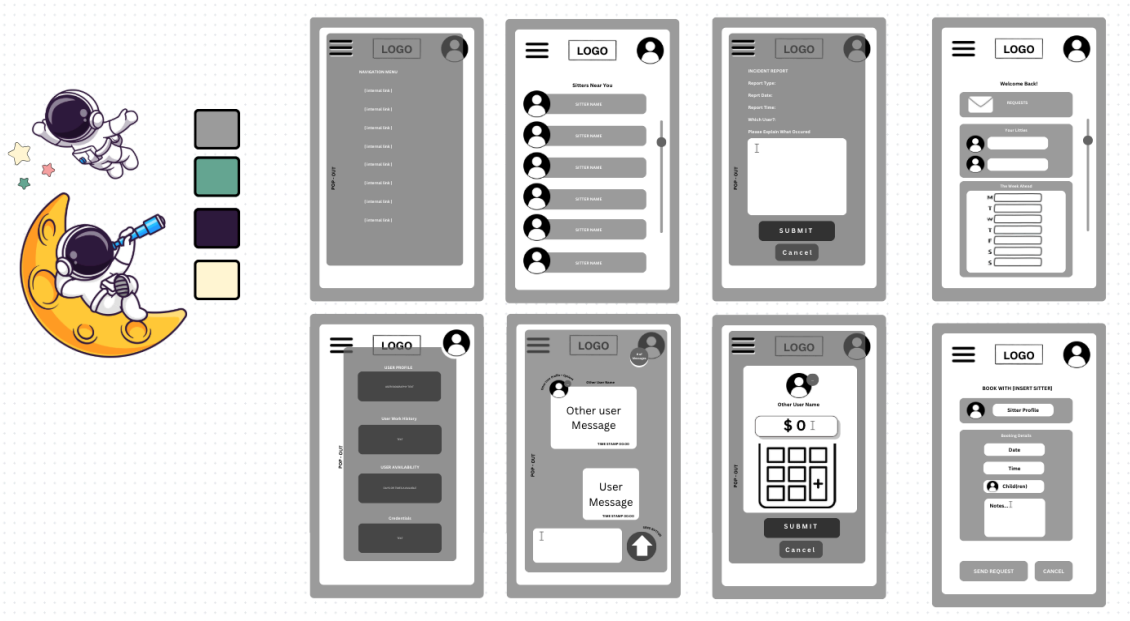
Class: SWE 5063
Assignment: Project Phase 3 - Report
Name: Haley Masenthin-Skinner, Devon Nelson, Camila Acosta, Austin Howell
Professor: Chenyu Wang

Summary

For our group project, we developed a responsive site called SitterSeek, a platform designed to connect parents with trusted, vetted babysitters in their area. Our goal was to create a user-friendly, database-driven site that allowed both parties to sign-up, create profiles, browse local options, and communicate efficiently. During our duration of the database build, we utilized a combination of MySQL2, Sequelize, GitHub (version control and collaboration), and Visual Studio Code (development). We believe this project emphasizes, not only our teamwork but, responsive design principles and real-world usability.

Our group collaborated to design and build a variety of pages to support core functionalities. These included the Home, Login, and Sign-Up pages to help users get started in creating their Parent or Sitter Profile. 'Sitters Near You' for parents to explore potential sitter matches in their area and 'Sitter Overview' for babysitters to stay up-to-date on their booking requests, "littles" (kids), and weekly schedule. Other essential features include a Chat, Booking Page, Payment Page, and Incident Report Page to support safe and seamless interactions between parents and sitters.

Each component was thoughtfully designed to enhance the user experience while maintaining a consistent, mobile-friendly interface.



The Hosted Site

https://baby-sitter-database-49ae12f0b6a4.herokuapp.com/

The Database

Database: MySQL hosted on Heroku with a JAWS_DB instance.
Tools in the project to connect to the database: Sequelize, MySQL2, Express.js, DBeaver.

We decided to host our database on heroku with a jaws_db instance. By doing this we could use one set of normalized data instead of working with different data points that could have disorganized our project if we were to each host our own local database.

For our database entities, we kept them as close to 3rd normalization by separating them out as much as possible. For example, when signing up the user creates a user entity, but when they go to make a profile they can either make a babysitter profile or parent profile that is connected to their user entity in a one-to-one relationship.

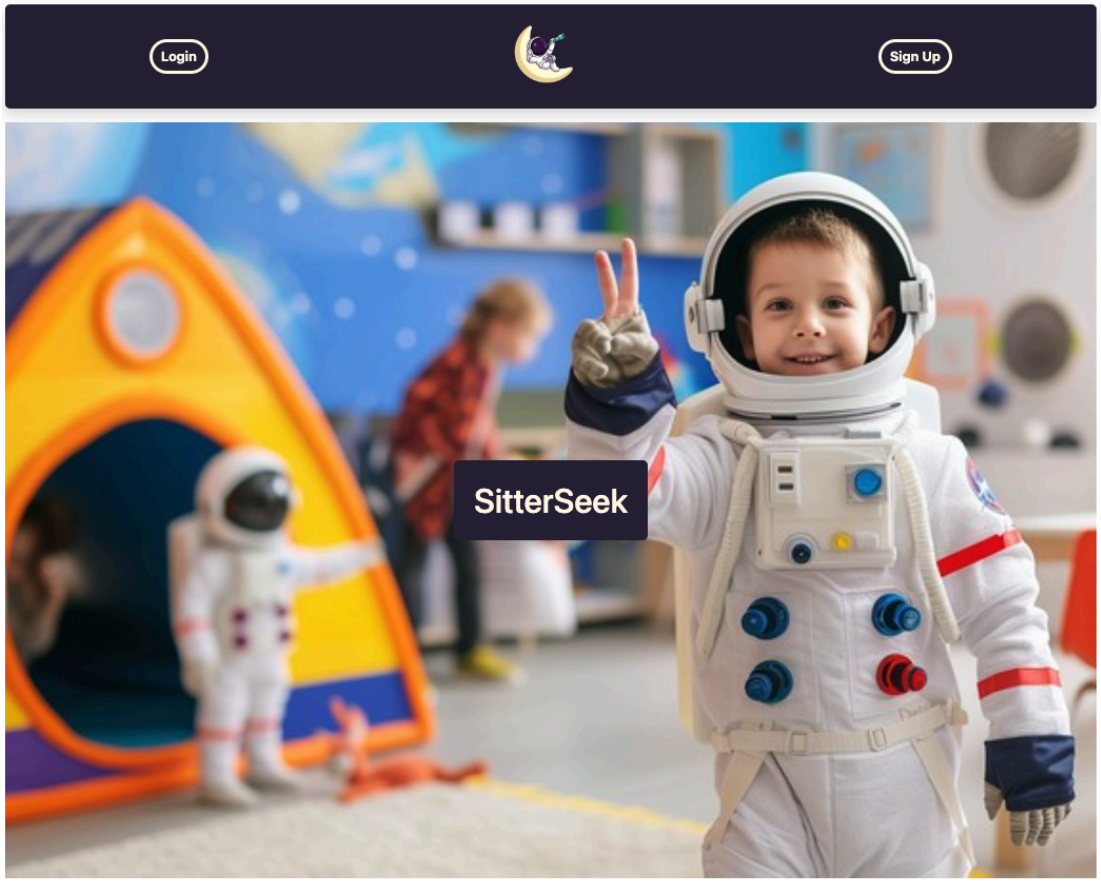
In using express.js along with sequelize and MySQL2, we were able to connect our database seamlessly to the frontend where handlebars.js was able to show our data points. You can specifically see this in action on our sitter/parent profile pages and in the sitters near you page.

The Homepage

Our first build was the Homepage. This served as the foundation for the rest of our SitterSeek project. As a team, we collaborated to design and implement a layout that was both visually inviting and intuitive. The Homepage offers clear options for existing users to login, new users to sign-up, or reach out via the SitterSeekHelp contact information in the footer. This ensured that users could easily navigate where they needed to go, whether they were a parent searching for childcare or a sitter looking for new opportunities.

Beyond functionality, we focused on creating a fun, welcoming atmosphere through playful color schemes, kid-friendly themes, and small design touches that reflected what SitterSeek was all about. The Homepage also includes our official pitch for SitterSeek; a short message explaining who we are, what services we offer, and why we stand out as a trusted solution for connecting parents and sitters.

This page offers an introduction that helps to build trust with users while maintaining a user-friendly layout!



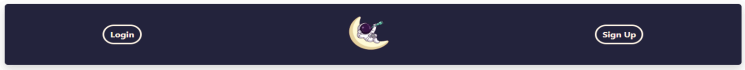
🚀 SitterSeek is launching child care into a whole new orbit!

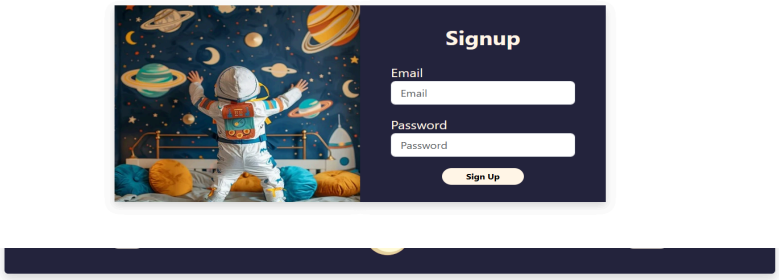
Your kid is one of a kind and their sitter should be, too. We help you find a match that's truly out of this world!

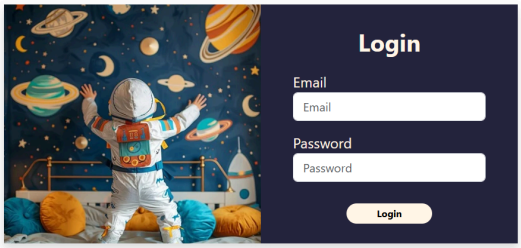
Find someone who gets their personality, routine, and imagination. Because great care should feel like it was written in the stars.

Login/Sign Up

The login and signup pages allow the users to either create a new account or to sign in and access their existing account. On the backend, we use bcrypt to encrypt the password to make sure it is safe and secure.

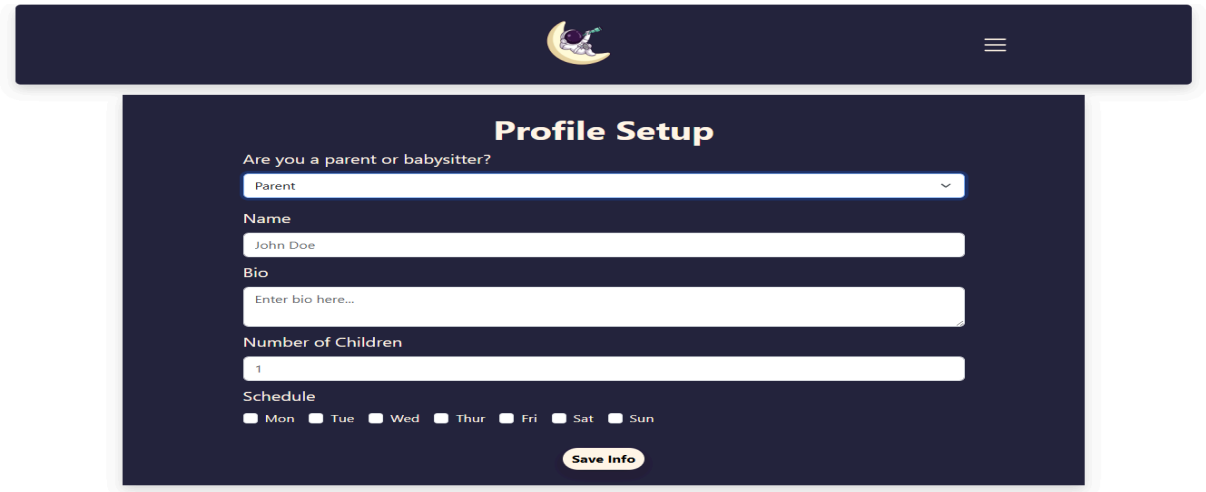






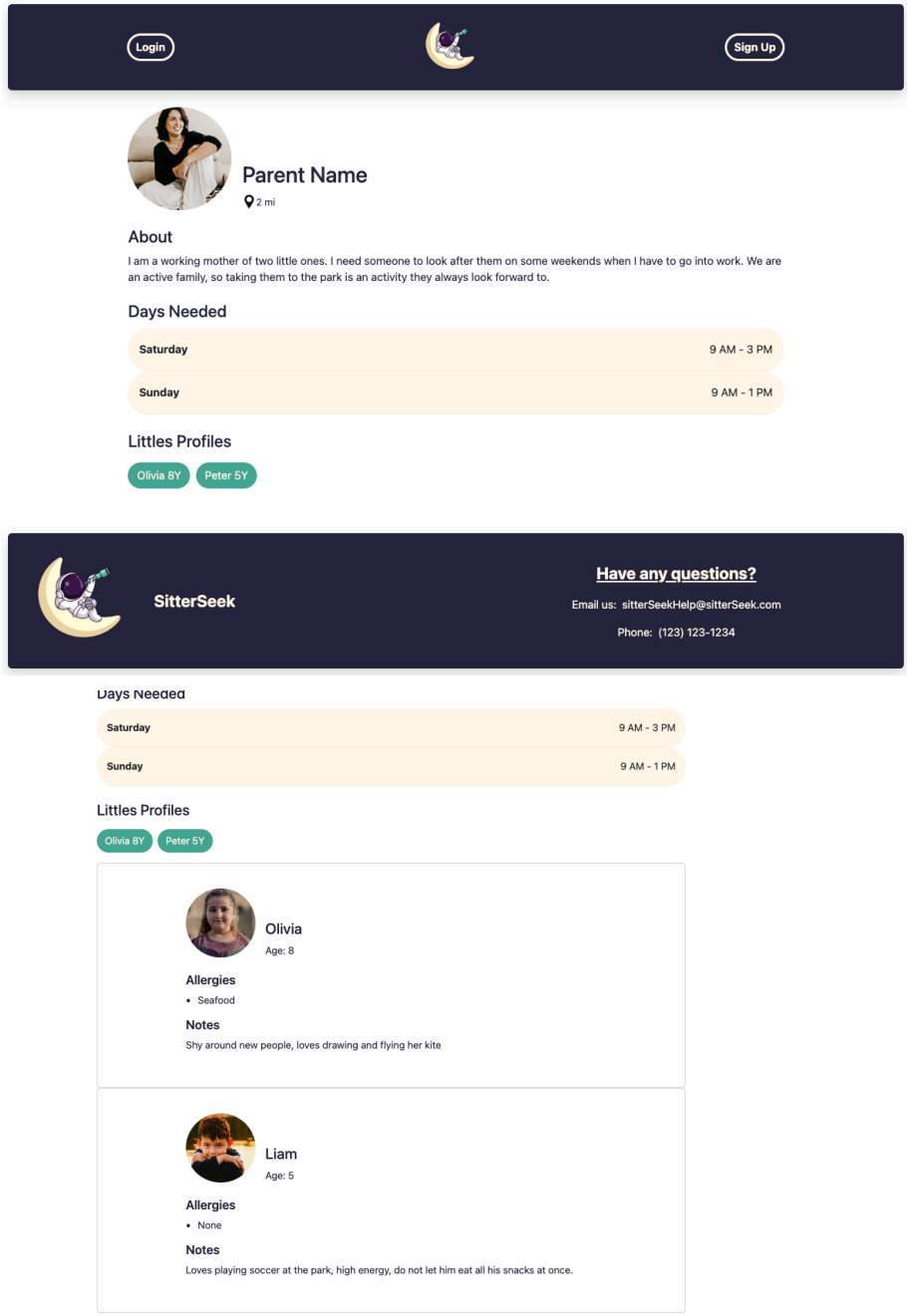
Profile Setup

After the user creates their account, they are redirected to the profile setup page. Here, they can choose between creating a parent profile or a babysitter profile. When these profiles are created the user_id is inserted so that we can connect the entities together. There is also a check for if a user already has a profile, then they are blocked from creating a new one.



Parent Profile

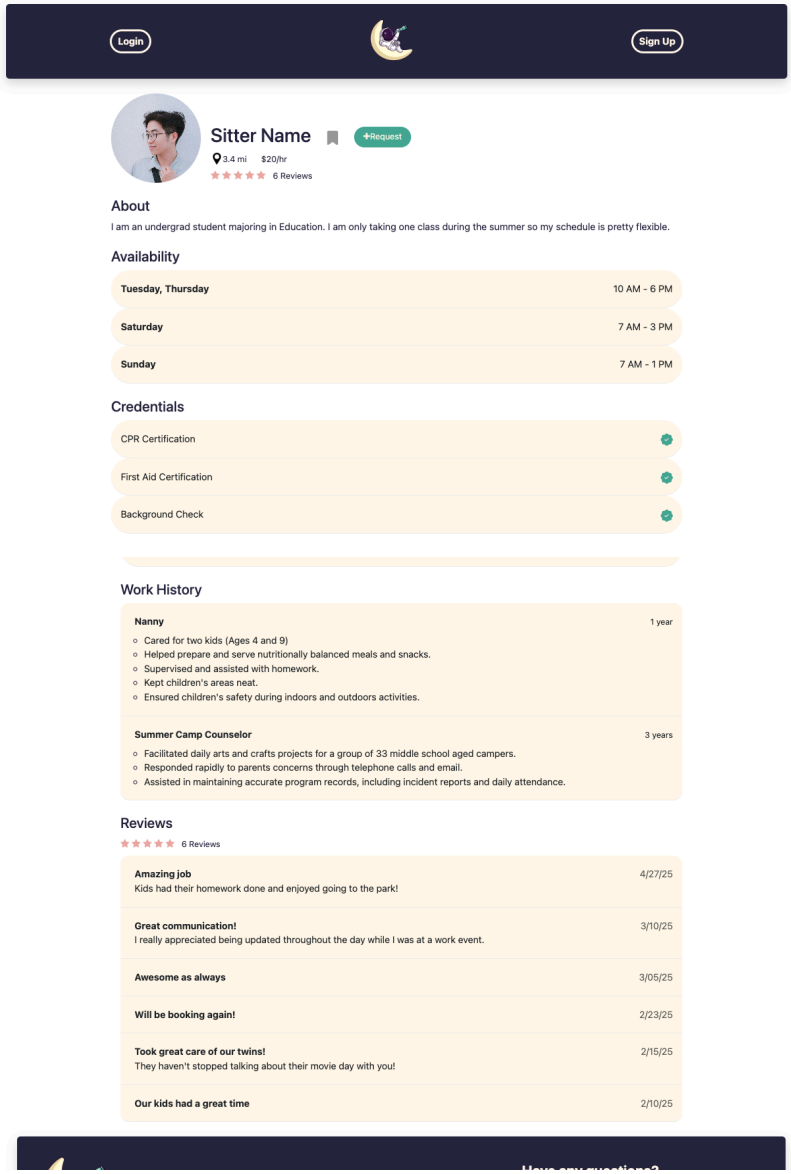
The parent profile page is where parents can write a little about themselves and display the days and times they need a babysitter. The parent's approximate location to the babysitter is shown for the sitter's consideration. The children's profiles are included on this page, containing pertinent information the babysitter would need about each child, such as allergies and notes left by the parent.



Sitter Profile

The sitter profile page has important information the parent would need to know when considering requesting a babysitter. The page displays the sitter's approximate location, availability, hourly rate, credentials, work history, and reviews from previous parents. The sitter

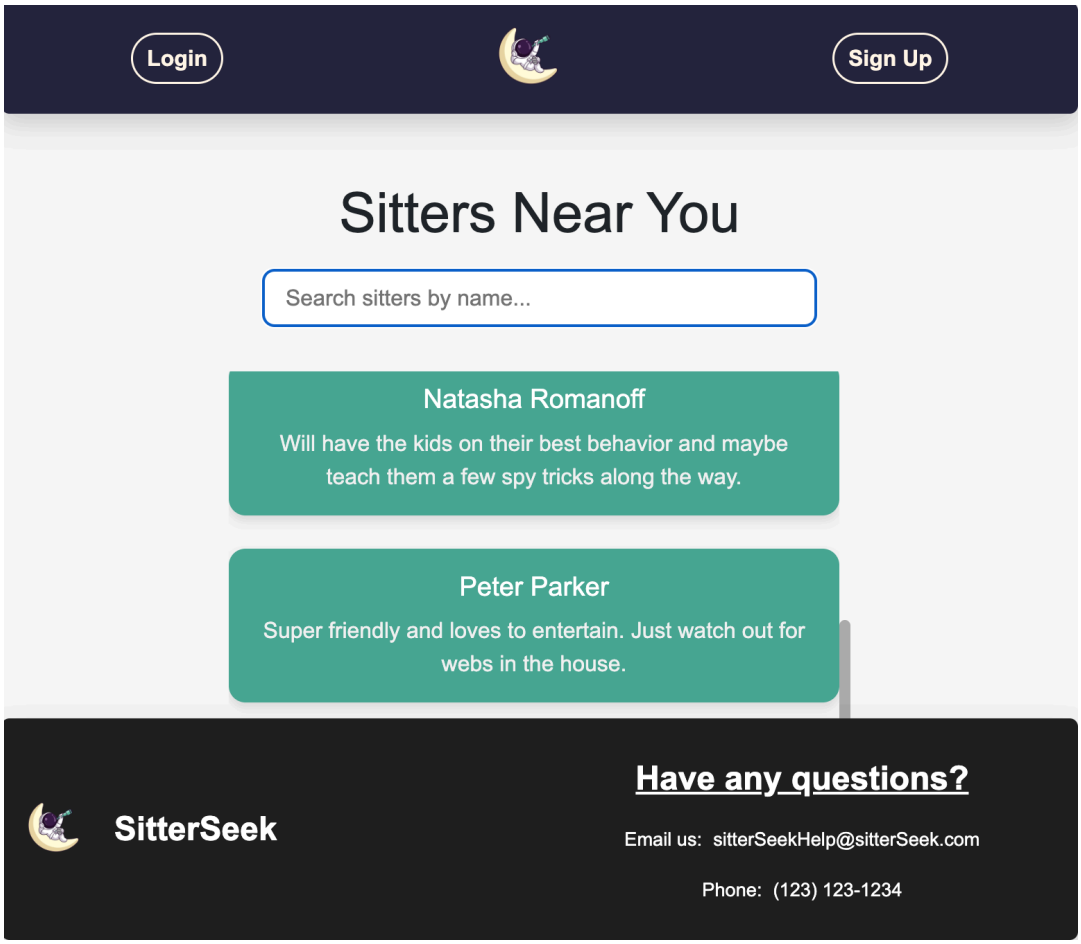
also has a section where they can write about themselves. Additionally, the parent has the option to save the sitter to their Saved Sitters and also request to book them.



Sitters Near You

The "Sitters Near You" page presents a list of available babysitters, each with a brief description. Parents can browse this list to find a suitable sitter or search the available records. The information displayed is pulled from a backend database, ensuring that any updates made are reflected in real-time.

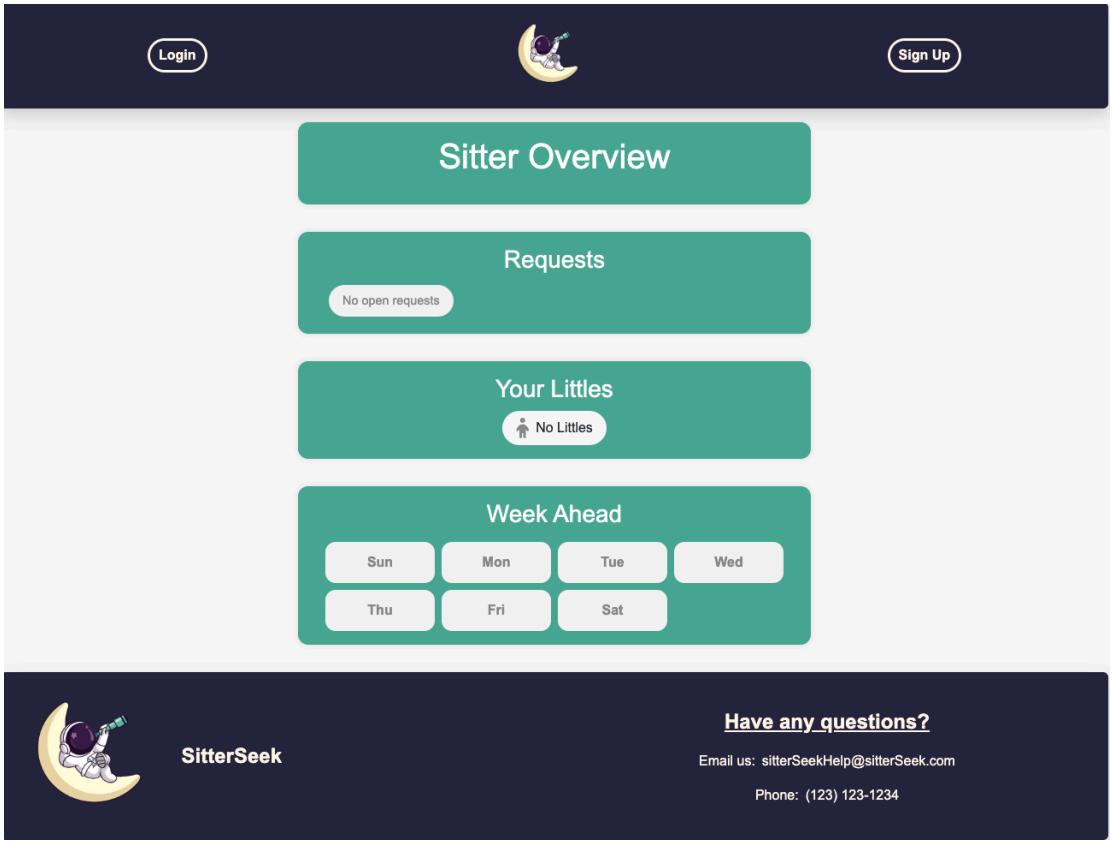
The page is designed to be responsive, adapting seamlessly to various screen sizes. This is due to the use of flexible layouts and media queries in the CSS, ensuring a consistent user experience across devices. This facilitates efficient, up-to-date sitter information to be displayed without manually refreshing!



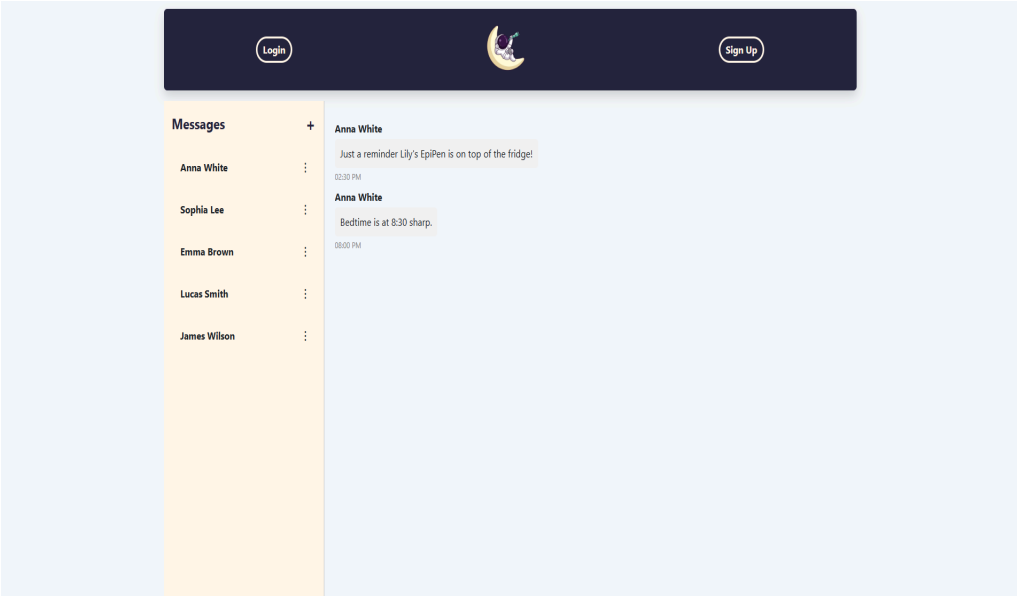
Sitter Overview

The Sitter Overview page gives babysitters a quick snapshot of their upcoming week. At a glance, they can see any scheduled activities, booking requests, and which kids ("littles") they're currently assigned to care for.

Sitters can also check their availability for the upcoming week through a simple day-by-day grid. If there are any requests or children assigned, those sections will populate automatically. Otherwise, placeholders are shown so the sitter knows there's nothing new yet. This page is mobile friendly and built for easy viewing/reference on the go.

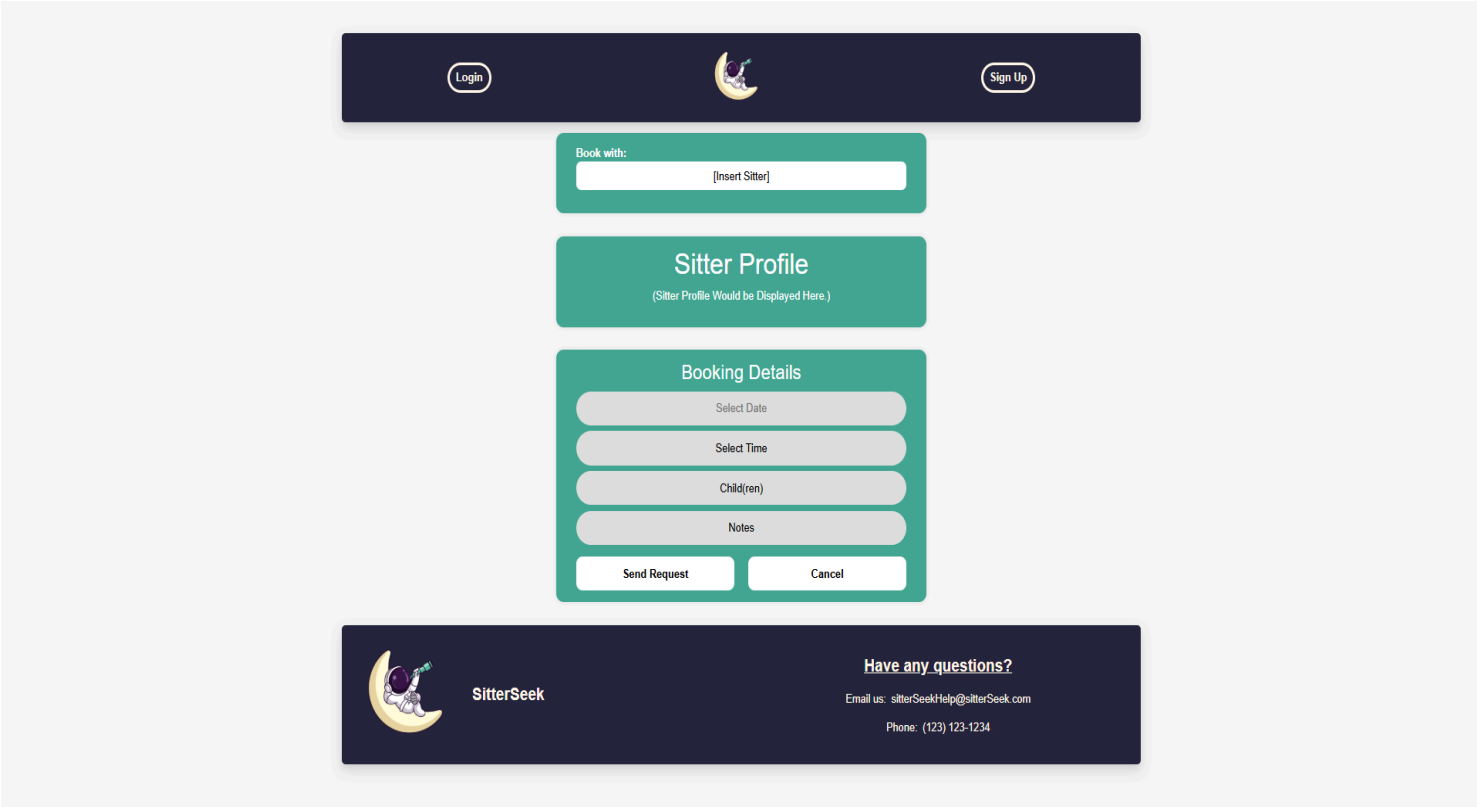

Login
Sign Up
Sitter Overview
Requests
No open requests
Your Littles
No Littles
Week Ahead
Sun
Mon
Tue
Wed
Thu
Fri
Sat
SitterSeek
Have any questions?
Email us: sitterSeekHelp@sitterSeek.com
Phone: (123) 123-1234

Chat



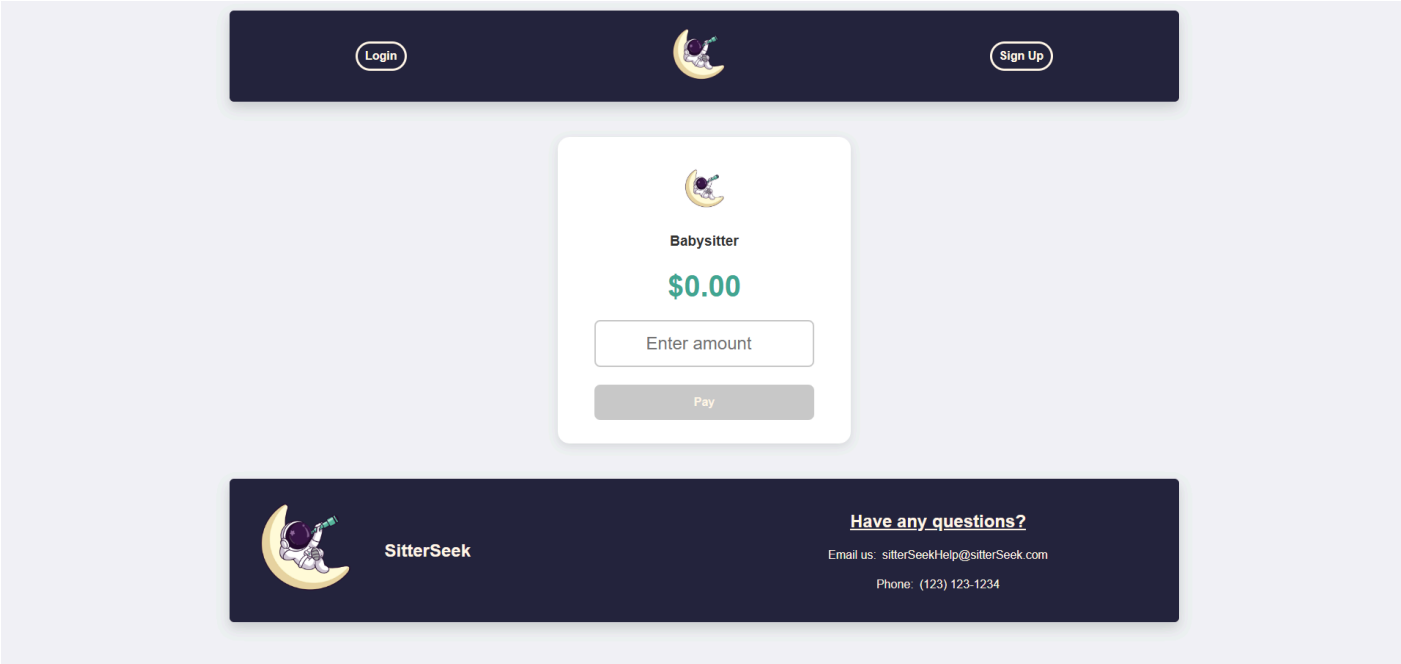
The chat box creates an environment between parents and babysitter. When you open it your conversations will be displayed on the left, making it easy to look through your conversations and allows you to check any messages you may have missed. Messages appear with names and also time stamps, so you always know who said what and when.

Booking



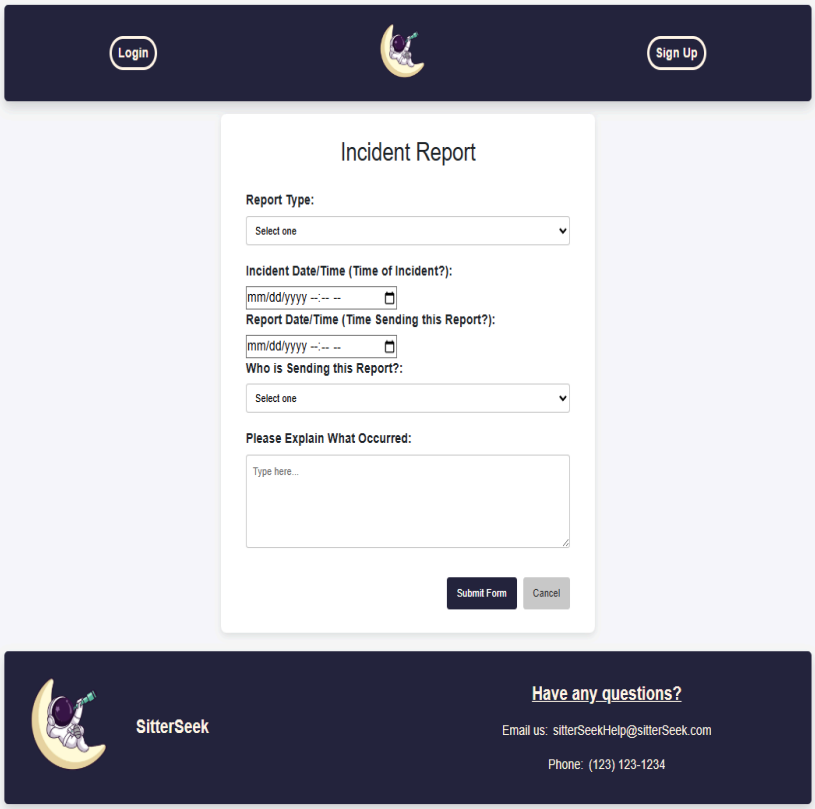
The Booking page is where you, as a parent, can schedule a time with a babysitter. From this screen you can view their profile once more before making the final decision. This includes double checking their experience, pay and any notes they might have. Speaking of notes you can leave a personal note to your selected babysitter at the bottom.

Pay Screen



The payment screen allows the parent to securely complete your transaction for your child's upcoming babysitter. After you have confirmed your booking, this page will appear. We have designed this page to be both simple and easy to use, whether you are on your phone or personal computer.

Incident Reports



This Incident Report allows both parents and babysitters a way to speak up when something deviates from the original plan. We all are aware that unexpected things happen from time to time. This could be a child having a minor accident to even the babysitter missing her booking appointment. You will be able to share what occurred, when it happened, and any extra personal notes as well.